

Lab Sheet 09

Title: ESP32 IoT System with MQTT and Node-RED Integration

Aims:

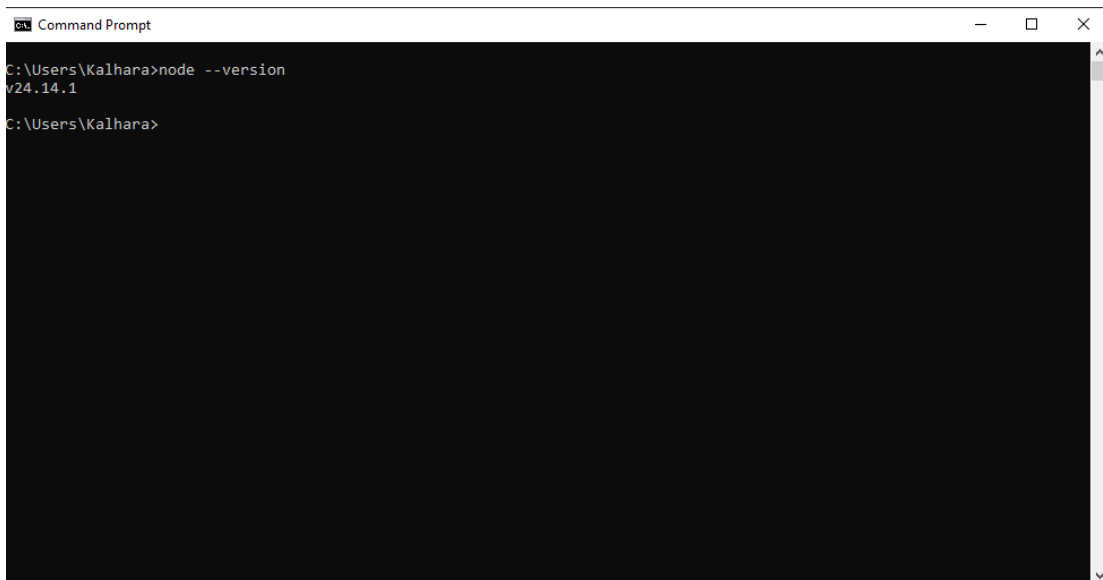
To design, simulate, and deploy an ESP32-based IoT system that publishes sensor data via MQTT and visualizes it using Node-RED dashboards. Learners will develop firmware, configure an MQTT broker, build Node-RED flows, and create real-time monitoring dashboards for a Smart Room Environmental Monitor.

Tasks: Smart Room Environmental Monitor

Part 1: Environment Setup

1. Install extensions in VS Code
 - a. MQTT Explorer – standalone MQTT client for debugging
 - b. PlatformIO IDE by PlatformIO – compile ESP32 firmware
 - c. Node.js (LTS) – required for Node-RED runtime

node --version



```
Command Prompt
C:\Users\Kalhara>node --version
v24.14.1
C:\Users\Kalhara>
```

- d. Wokwi by Wokwi – browser-based ESP32 simulator
2. Install Node-RED globally via npm:

```
npm install -g --unsafe-perm node-red
```

```
C:\Users\Kalhara>node --version
v24.14.1

C:\Users\Kalhara>npm install -g --unsafe-perm node-red
npm warn "node-red" is being parsed as a normal command line argument.
npm warn Unknown cli config "--unsafe-perm". This will stop working in the next major version of npm.

added 5 packages, removed 62 packages, and changed 365 packages in 3m

70 packages are looking for funding
  run `npm fund` for details

C:\Users\Kalhara>
```

3. Install an MQTT Broker (Mosquitto):

- a. Download from <https://mosquitto.org/download/>
- b. After install, start the broker:

i. `mosquitto -v`

```
Command Prompt

C:\Users\Kalhara>npm install -g --unsafe-perm node-red
npm warn "node-red" is being parsed as a normal command line argument.
npm warn Unknown cli config "--unsafe-perm". This will stop working in the next major version of npm.

added 5 packages, removed 62 packages, and changed 365 packages in 3m

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C:\Users\Kalhara>mosquitto -v
1783178338: mosquitto version 2.1.2 starting
1783178338: Using default config.
1783178338: Bridge support available.
1783178338: Persistence support available.
1783178338: TLS support available.
1783178338: TLS-PSK support available.
1783178338: Websockets support available.
1783178338: Starting in local only mode. Connections will only be possible from clients running on this machine.
1783178338: Create a configuration file which defines a listener to allow remote access.
1783178338: For more details see https://mosquitto.org/documentation/authentication-methods/
1783178338: Opening ipv4 listen socket on port 1883.
1783178338: Error: Only one usage of each socket address (protocol/network address/port) is normally permitted.

1783178338: Opening ipv6 listen socket on port 1883.
1783178338: Error: Only one usage of each socket address (protocol/network address/port) is normally permitted.

1783178338: mosquitto version 2.1.2 terminating

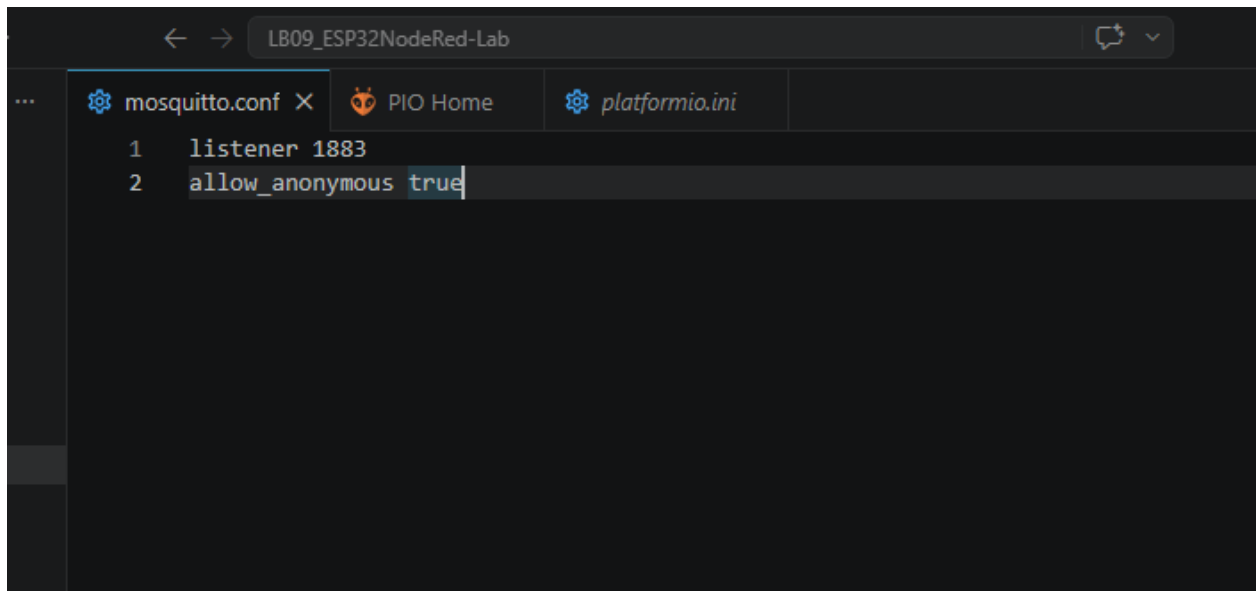
C:\Users\Kalhara>
```

c. Create file named **mosquitto.conf** and save on working folder.

i. Type below codes:

listener 1883

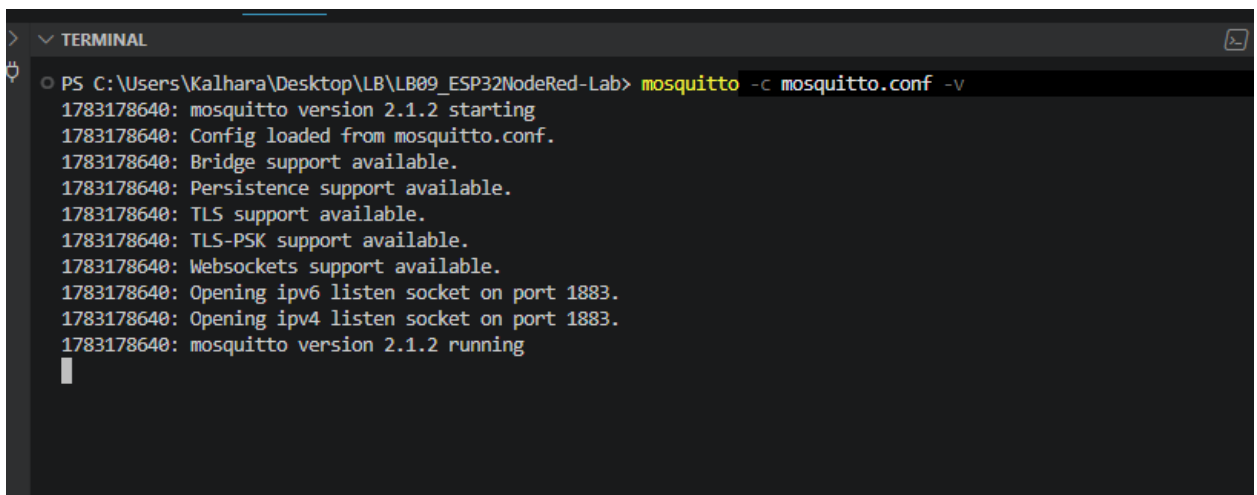
allow_anonymous true



The screenshot shows a code editor window titled "LB09_ESP32NodeRed-Lab". The editor has three tabs: "mosquitto.conf", "PIO Home", and "platformio.ini". The "mosquitto.conf" tab is active, showing two lines of code: "1 listener 1883" and "2 allow_anonymous true". The cursor is at the end of the second line.

d. Start the broker.

i. In cmd : *mosquitto -c mosquitto.conf -v*

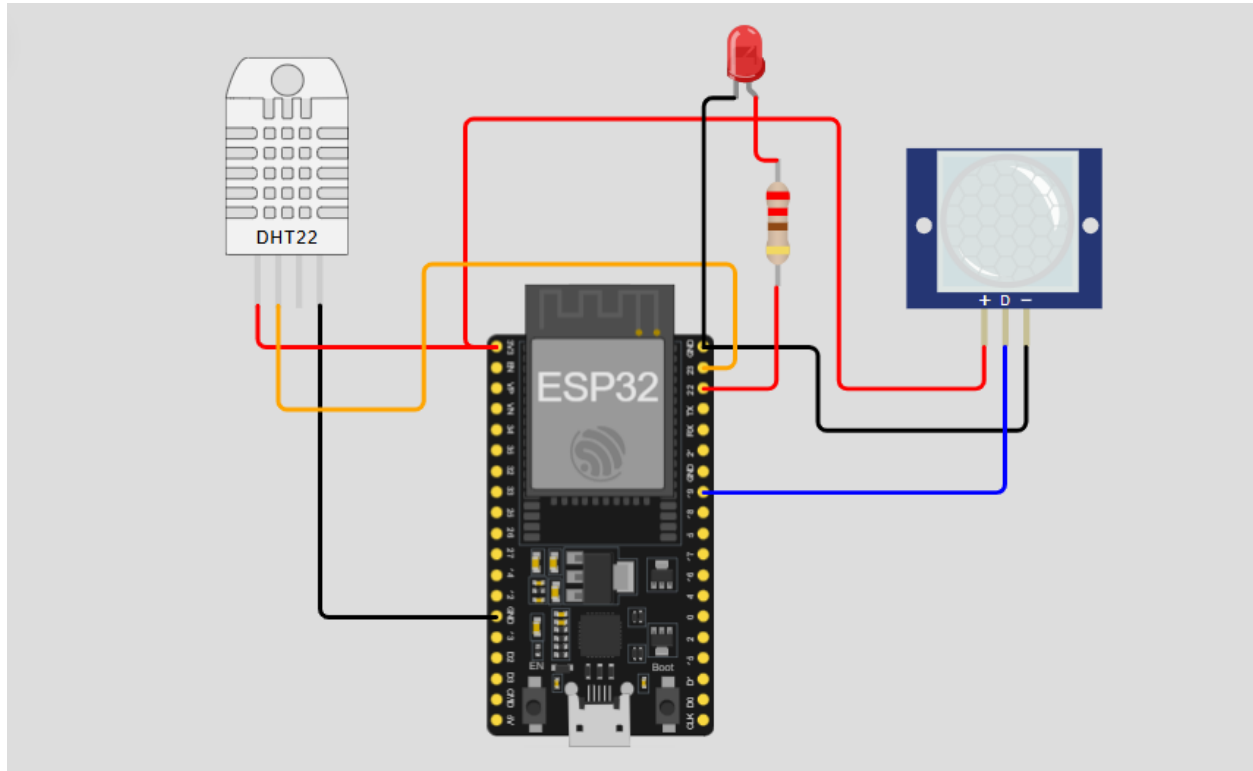


The screenshot shows a terminal window titled "TERMINAL". The command prompt is "PS C:\Users\Kalhara\Desktop\LB\LB09_ESP32NodeRed-Lab>". The command entered is "mosquitto -c mosquitto.conf -v". The output is as follows:

```
1783178640: mosquitto version 2.1.2 starting
1783178640: Config loaded from mosquitto.conf.
1783178640: Bridge support available.
1783178640: Persistence support available.
1783178640: TLS support available.
1783178640: TLS-PSK support available.
1783178640: Websockets support available.
1783178640: Opening ipv6 listen socket on port 1883.
1783178640: Opening ipv4 listen socket on port 1883.
1783178640: mosquitto version 2.1.2 running
```

Part 2: Project Setup in Wokwi / VS Code

1. Name the project **ESP32NodeRed-Lab**.
2. Circuit Design
 - a) Connect the DHT22 sensor to an ESP32 GPIO pin.
 - b) Connect the PIR sensor to an ESP32 GPIO pin.
 - c) Connect the LED to the ESP32.



3. Library Integration

- a) PubSubClient
- b) DHT sensor library

```
[env:esp32dev]
platform = espressif32
board = esp32dev
framework = arduino
lib_deps =
  adafruit/DHT sensor library@1.4.7
  knolleary/PubSubClient@2.8
```

4. Configure Node-RED

a. Launch Node-RED

```
C:\Users\Kalhara>node-red
4 Jul 21:18:41 - [info]

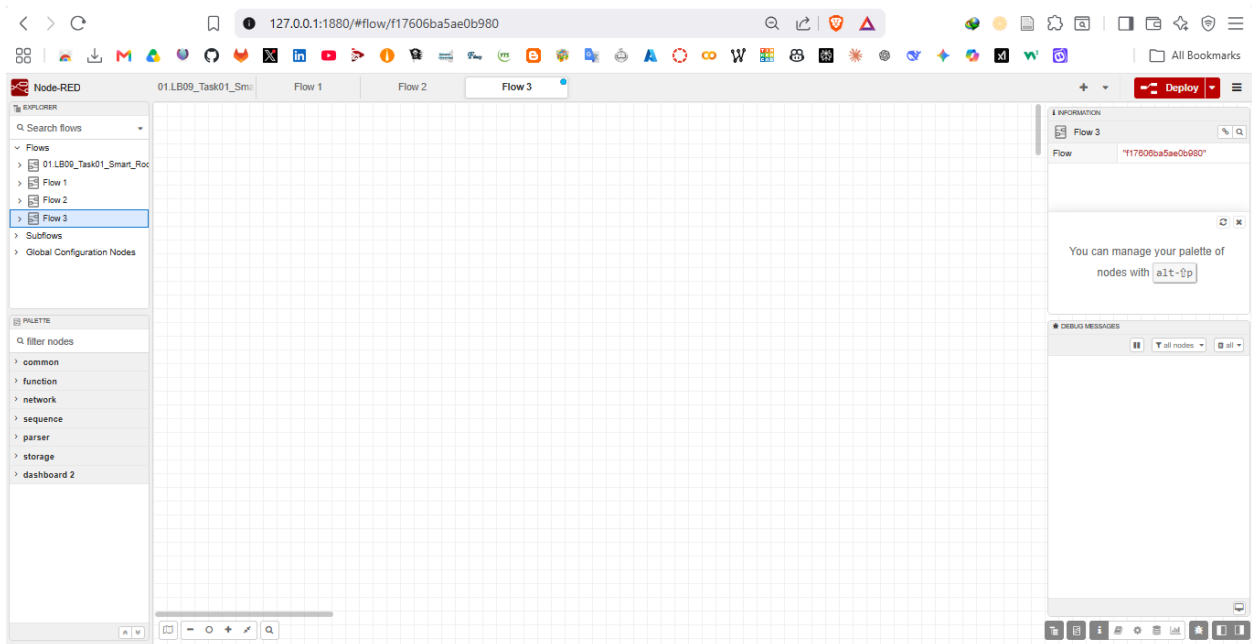
Welcome to Node-RED
=====

4 Jul 21:18:41 - [info] Node-RED version: v5.0.1
4 Jul 21:18:41 - [info] Node.js version: v24.14.1
4 Jul 21:18:41 - [info] Windows_NT 10.0.19045 x64 LE
4 Jul 21:18:43 - [info] Loading palette nodes
4 Jul 21:19:05 - [info] Settings file : C:\Users\Kalhara\.node-red\settings.js
4 Jul 21:19:05 - [info] Context store : 'default' [module=memory]
4 Jul 21:19:05 - [info] User directory : \Users\Kalhara\.node-red
4 Jul 21:19:05 - [warn] Projects disabled : editorTheme.projects.enabled=false
4 Jul 21:19:05 - [info] Flows file : \Users\Kalhara\.node-red\flows.json
4 Jul 21:19:05 - [warn]

-----
Your flow credentials file is encrypted using a system-generated key.

If the system-generated key is lost for any reason, your credentials
file will not be recoverable, you will have to delete it and re-enter
your credentials.

You should set your own key using the 'credentialSecret' option in
your settings file. Node-RED will then re-encrypt your credentials
file using your chosen key the next time you deploy a change.
```



b. Install Required Nodes

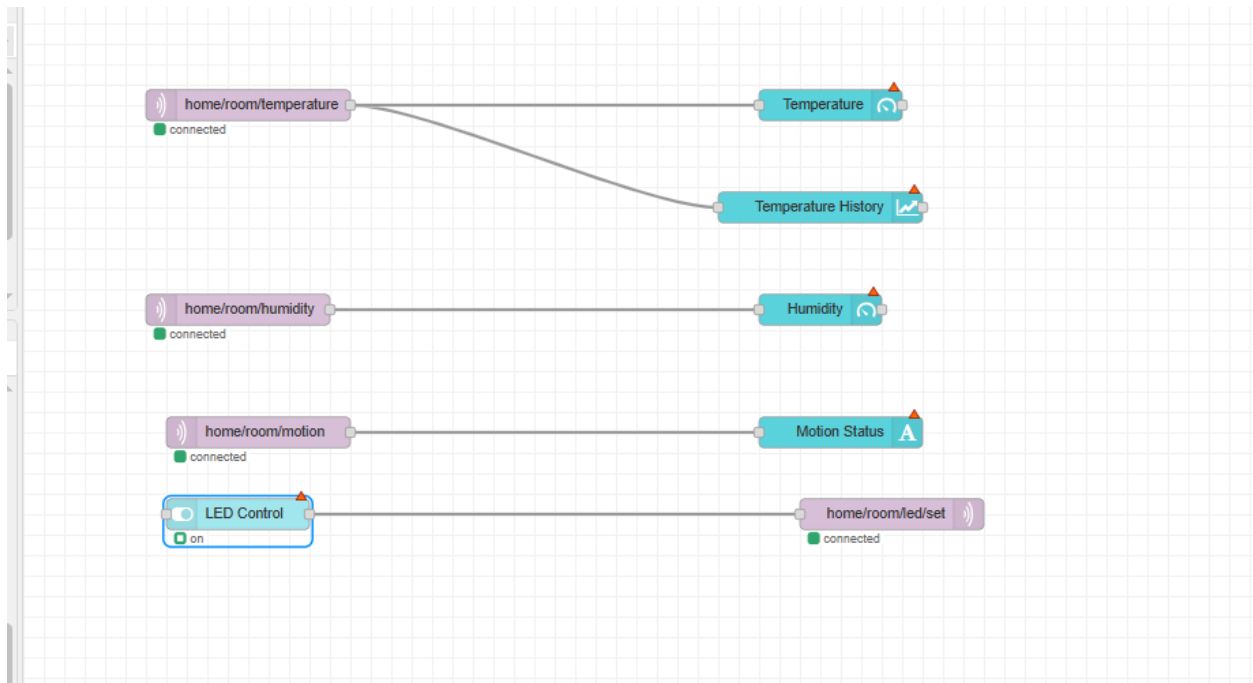
i. @flowfuse/node-red-dashboard

c. Build the MQTT Subscriber Flow

Node	Type	Configuration
Temperature Flow		
mqtt in	Input	Topic: home/room/temperature, Server: ip_address:1883
gauge	Dashboard	Label: Temperature, Min: 0, Max: 80, Unit: °C
chart	Dashboard	Label: Temperature History
Humidity Flow		
mqtt in	Input	Topic: home/room/humidity Server: ip_address:1883
gauge	Dashboard	Label: Humidity, Min: 0, Max: 100, Unit: %
Motion Detection Flow		
mqtt in	Input	Topic: home/room/motion
text	Dashboard	Label: Motion Status
LED Control Flow		
switch	Dashboard	Label: LED Control, On Payload: ON, Off Payload: OFF
mqtt out	Output	Topic: home/room/led/set, Server: ip_address:1883

d. Click Deploy (top-right red button) after wiring all nodes.

e. Open the dashboard at <http://localhost:1880/dashboard> to view live data.



5. Programming Logic Development in Wokwi / VS Code

- Initialize Wi-Fi and MQTT connection to enable network communication between ESP32 and the broker.
- Read temperature and humidity values from the DHT22 sensor using the appropriate sensor library.
- Read and process PIR sensor data for motion detection.
- Publish all sensor readings to MQTT topics in real time for Node-RED dashboard visualization.

```
#include <Arduino.h>
#include <WiFi.h>
#include <PubSubClient.h>
#include <DHT.h>

// Wi-Fi and MQTT Configurations
const char* ssid = "Wokwi-GUEST";
const char* password = "";
const char* mqtt_server = "192.168.116.232";

// Pin Definitions
```

```

#define DHTPIN 23
#define DHTTYPE DHT22
#define PIR_PIN 19
#define LED_PIN 22

// MQTT Topics
#define TOPIC_TEMP "home/room/temperature"
#define TOPIC_HUMID "home/room/humidity"
#define TOPIC_MOTION "home/room/motion"
#define TOPIC_LED_SET "home/room/led/set"

DHT dht(DHTPIN, DHTTYPE);
WiFiClient espClient;
PubSubClient client(espClient);

unsigned long lastMsg = 0;

void setup_wifi() {
    delay(10);
    Serial.println();
    Serial.print("Connecting to ");
    Serial.println(ssid);

    WiFi.mode(WIFI_STA);
    WiFi.begin(ssid, password);

    while (WiFi.status() != WL_CONNECTED) {
        delay(500);
        Serial.print(".");
    }

    Serial.println("");
    Serial.println("WiFi connected");
    Serial.print("IP address: ");
    Serial.println(WiFi.localIP());
}

// MQTT හරහා පණිවිඩ ලැබෙන විට ක්‍රියාත්මක වන ශ්‍රිතය (Callback)
void callback(char* topic, byte* payload, unsigned int length) {
    Serial.print("Message arrived [");
    Serial.print(topic);
    Serial.print("] ");

    String message = "";
    for (int i = 0; i < length; i++) {

```



```

    message += (char)payload[i];
}
Serial.println(message);

// LED එක පාලනය කිරීම
if (String(topic) == TOPIC_LED_SET) {
    if (message == "ON") {
        digitalWrite(LED_PIN, HIGH);
        Serial.println("LED turned ON");
    } else if (message == "OFF") {
        digitalWrite(LED_PIN, LOW);
        Serial.println("LED turned OFF");
    }
}
}

void reconnect() {
    while (!client.connected()) {
        Serial.print("Attempting MQTT connection...");
        String clientId = "ESP32Client-";
        clientId += String(random(0xffff), HEX);

        if (client.connect(clientId.c_str())) {
            Serial.println("connected");
            // LED Topic එක Subscribe කිරීම
            client.subscribe(TOPIC_LED_SET);
        } else {
            Serial.print("failed, rc=");
            Serial.print(client.state());
            Serial.println(" try again in 5 seconds");
            delay(5000);
        }
    }
}

void setup() {
    Serial.begin(115200);
    pinMode(PIR_PIN, INPUT);
    pinMode(LED_PIN, OUTPUT);

    dht.begin();
    setup_wifi();
    client.setServer(mqtt_server, 1883);
    client.setCallback(callback);
}

```

```

void loop() {
  if (!client.connected()) {
    reconnect();
  }
  client.loop();

  unsigned long now = millis();

  if (now - lastMsg > 2000) {
    lastMsg = now;

    // DHT22 දත්ත කියවීම
    float h = dht.readHumidity();
    float t = dht.readTemperature();

    int motionDetected = digitalRead(PIR_PIN);

    if (isnan(h) || isnan(t)) {
      Serial.println("Failed to read from DHT sensor!");
      return;
    }

    Serial.print("Temp: "); Serial.print(t);
    Serial.print(" | Humid: "); Serial.print(h);
    Serial.print(" | Motion: "); Serial.println(motionDetected ? "MOTION!" : "No
Motion");

    client.publish(TOPIC_TEMP, String(t).c_str());
    client.publish(TOPIC_HUMID, String(h).c_str());
    client.publish(TOPIC_MOTION, motionDetected ? "Motion Detected" : "Clear");
  }
}

```

6. Simulation & Testing in Wokwi / VS Code

- a. Run simulation
- b. Adjust values in Wokwi / VS Code
- c. Verify Node-RED interaction

PROBLEMS

OUTPUT

TERMINAL

▼ TERMINAL

```
Temp: 53.30 | Humid: 64.50 | Motion: No Motion
Temp: 53.30 | Humid: 64.50 | Motion: No Motion
Temp: 53.30 | Humid: 64.50 | Motion: No Motion
Temp: 53.30 | Humid: 64.50 | Motion: No Motion
Message arrived [home/room/led/set] ON
LED turned ON
Temp: -5.20 | Humid: 42.50 | Motion: MOTION!
Temp: -5.20 | Humid: 42.50 | Motion: MOTION!
Temp: -5.20 | Humid: 42.50 | Motion: No Motion
Temp: -5.20 | Humid: 42.50 | Motion: No Motion
```

